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RETAIN

Learning under crisis: how Eastern Europe, Caucasus, and Central Asia countries build educational system resilience

CEDOS research analyzes how GPE partner countries cope with systemic educational disruptions caused by armed conflicts, natural disasters, and health crises. The study finds that crises not only interrupt learning but deepen longstanding structural problems: unequal access, weak teacher training quality, and fragile digital infrastructure. System resilience is framed not as

the ability to merely 'survive' a crisis but as the capacity to adapt and continue building competencies even under extreme conditions.

3R: RETAIN-type signal: educational resilience is the enabling condition for human capital accumulation. When an education system cannot function under crisis, reskilling loses its institutional base and brain waste deepens as the system structurally fails to produce demanded competencies. For Ukraine the analogy is direct: sustainable human capital reproduction is impossible without a resilient educational infrastructure under ongoing war conditions.

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